BRIDGEPORT AVENUE ELEMENTARY SCHOOL
Hartford Public Schools
1540 Bridgeport Avenue, Hartford, CT 06106
(860) 555-0300
PARENT ADVISORY COUNCIL
FALL 2025 MEETING -- AGENDA AND MINUTES
Date: Thursday, November 13, 2025
Time: 6:00 PM to 7:45 PM
Location: Bridgeport Avenue Elementary School Library
Presiding: Shanice R. Giles, Principal
ATTENDEES
School Administration: Shanice R. Giles (Principal), Valerie Moss (Assistant Principal), Rose Delaney (Admin
Assistant)
Parent and Guardian Representatives: Delia Morales, Anthony Reyes, Tamika Brown, Jasmine Carter, Omar
Salazar, Fatima Al-Rashid, Kwame Osei, Nadia Petrov, Carmen Santiago, Robert and Diane Hutchins
Community Member: Reverend Terrell Banks (West End community liaison)
Total in attendance: 24 (sign-in sheet on file)
Regrets received: 3 (noted; school follows up with written summary)
CALL TO ORDER AND WELCOME
Principal Giles called the meeting to order at 6:05 PM and welcomed families. She acknowledged that evenings
are difficult to give up and thanked every person for making the time. She noted that the parent advisory council is
one of the most important feedback mechanisms the school has and that decisions made in this room affect real
children.
Valerie Moss led a brief icebreaker: each attendee shared their child's name, grade, and one word to describe
how the school year was going so far.
AGENDA ITEM 1 -- OPENING REMARKS AND SCHOOL YEAR UPDATE
Principal Giles provided an overview of the school year to date:
Enrollment: 421 students as of October 31, 2025.
Staffing: All teaching positions filled; one long-term substitute covering a maternity leave in 2nd grade (expected
original teacher return January 2026).
Attendance: School-wide attendance rate at 93.4% through October; on track with school improvement plan target
of 94%.
Chronic absenteeism: 14 students currently identified at Tier 2 or Tier 3; individual outreach underway.
Celebrations: School received a community partnership grant of $8,000 from the West End Neighborhood
Association to support the family resource room and literacy events.
AGENDA ITEM 2 -- STATE TESTING RESULTS (SPRING 2025) -- OVERVIEW
Valerie Moss presented a summary of the spring 2025 Connecticut Mastery Test results.

Overall school proficiency rates:
ELA, Grade 3: 41% at or above proficiency (state average 52%)
ELA, Grade 4: 38% at or above proficiency (state average 54%)
ELA, Grade 5: 44% at or above proficiency (state average 56%)
Math, Grade 3: 36% at or above proficiency (state average 49%)
Math, Grade 4: 33% at or above proficiency (state average 51%)
Math, Grade 5: 39% at or above proficiency (state average 53%)
Principal Giles contextualized the data: these gaps reflect real inequities in resources and opportunity that go
beyond what any school can fix alone. The school's job is to close the gap as much as possible, and that requires
the partnership of families.
She noted two areas of improvement over 2024: ELA Grade 3 improved 4 points; Math Grade 5 improved nearly 3
points.
Parent Question (Tamika Brown): What is the school doing specifically to improve math?
Response (Moss): We added a Title I math interventionist this year who works with small groups in Grades 3 to 5.
We also adopted new supplemental materials aligned to the standards. We will see that investment show up in
2026 results.
Parent Question (Omar Salazar): My son is in Grade 4 and his teacher says he is doing fine. How do I know if his
scores match what she tells me?
Response (Giles): Every family received a score report in the fall. If yours did not arrive or if you want help reading
it, see Rose at the front desk. We will also hold a family data night in January to walk families through the reports
together.
AGENDA ITEM 3 -- SCHOOL IMPROVEMENT PLAN PRIORITIES -- 2025-2026
Principal Giles presented the three school improvement plan priorities for 2025-2026:
Priority 1: Literacy. Goal: Increase ELA proficiency in Grades 3 to 5 by 5 percentage points over the spring 2025 baseline by the end of the 2025-2026 school year. Strategy: Structured literacy blocks, small-group
intervention, family literacy nights (four per year).
Priority 2: Math. Goal: Increase Math proficiency in Grades 3 to 5 by 4 percentage points over baseline. Strategy: Math interventionist, Bridges supplemental kits, data-driven grade-level planning meetings.
Priority 3: Chronic Absenteeism. Goal: Reduce chronic absenteeism rate from 8.2% (spring 2025 year-end) to 6.5% by the end of the 2025-2026 school year. Strategy: Tiered outreach, home visits for Tier 3, attendance
incentive program, family engagement events.
Parent Feedback (Nadia Petrov): She asked whether the family literacy nights are available in languages other
than English.
Response (Giles): Yes. We have Spanish interpretation available at all family events. We are working on adding
Portuguese and Somali resources. If families need another language, please contact Rose in advance and we will
do our best to arrange support.
AGENDA ITEM 4 -- FAMILY CONCERNS AND OPEN FORUM
Principal Giles opened the floor for general concerns. The following were raised:

Concern 1 (Delia Morales): The main entrance wait times at morning drop-off are very long, sometimes 10 to 15 minutes.

Response: Principal Giles acknowledged the bottleneck. She is working with the district on a modified traffic flow plan. Interim solution: A second entrance will open at the east gate beginning November 17 for families who use the side street.

Concern 2 (Robert Hutchins): Cafeteria noise level during lunch is very high. His daughter says she cannot hear friends and comes home with a headache.

Response: Valerie Moss noted this has been flagged by staff as well. The school is piloting a quiet signal protocol starting next week. Results will be evaluated in January.

Concern 3 (Jasmine Carter): Recess is too short and kids are not getting enough outdoor time.

Response: Principal Giles explained that the recess schedule is constrained by the district master schedule. She is drafting a proposal to the district for an additional 10-minute outdoor period for K to 2. She will update the council at the spring meeting.

Concern 4 (Fatima Al-Rashid): She is concerned her child's reading group level is too low and wants to understand how placements are made.

Response: Principal Giles invited her to schedule a conference with the classroom teacher and the literacy interventionist. Rose will follow up with her contact information after the meeting.

AGENDA ITEM 5 -- UPCOMING EVENTS

Rose Delaney reviewed upcoming school events:

November 18 and 19, 2025: Parent-Teacher Conferences, 3:30 to 7:30 PM

December 10, 2025: Holiday Concert, 6:00 PM, school auditorium

January 2026: Family Math Night (date TBD, confirmed by December 15)

February 2026: 100th Day of School celebrations

Late spring (date to be confirmed): 5th Grade Promotion Ceremony, 6:00 PM

CLOSING REMARKS

Principal Giles thanked families for coming and reminded them that the school's success depends on the partnership between home and school. She invited anyone with additional concerns to email her directly at sgiles@hartfordschools.org.

Meeting adjourned at 7:43 PM.

Light refreshments provided. Childcare was available in the gymnasium during the meeting.

Minutes recorded by: Rose Delaney, Administrative Assistant

Reviewed by: Shanice R. Giles, Principal

Distribution: All attendees (email); posted to school website; hard copy in main office